

ANTIMICROBIAL STEWARDSHIP COMMITTEE AND PROGRAMS (ASP)

CHARTER

VA Ann Arbor Healthcare System
Ann Arbor, MI 48105

Rescinded Document:
August 27, 2024

Signatory Authority:
Ginny L. Creasman, Pharm.D., FACHE
Medical Center Director

Effective Date:
December 1, 2024

Responsible Owner:
Antimicrobial Stewardship Co-Chairs

Recertification Date:
December 1, 2029

Reports To:
Pharmacy and Therapeutics Committee

1. PURPOSE

The purpose of this charter is to facilitate the optimal use of antimicrobial agents for treating infections in patients within the VA Ann Arbor Healthcare System (VAAHS), to ensure cost-effective therapy and improve patient outcomes while containing bacterial resistance, and to educate health care providers on the safe and effective use of antimicrobial agents.

2. SCOPE

a. **Reporting Structure.** This committee reports to Pharmacy and Therapeutics Committee.

b. **Reporting Committees and Programs.** None

c. **Mandate.** This committee was established by a mandate in VHA Directive 1031 Antimicrobial Stewardship Programs.

d. **Membership.** Members of the ASP Committee include microbiology laboratory staff, IT support, other physician specialties, nursing staff, and clinical pharmacists. The Hospital Epidemiologist, Infection Control Coordinator, and Multi-Drug-Resistant Organism Coordinator may be called for consultation on an ad hoc basis.

(1) Chair(s).

(a) Infectious Diseases Clinical Pharmacy Director

(b) Infectious Diseases Physician Medical Director

(2) Voting Members.

(a) ASP Medical Director

- (b) ASP Pharmacist Director
- (c) Chief, Division of Infectious Diseases
- (d) Infection Prevention & Epidemiology Medical Director
- (e) Microbiology Lab Director
- (f) Other physician specialties
 - 1. Hospital Medicine
 - 2. Pulmonary and Critical Care Medicine
 - 3. Primary Care
 - 4. Community Living Center
 - 5. Surgery
- (g) Clinical Pharmacy representatives(s)
- (h) Infectious Diseases physician representative(s)
- (i) Nursing representative(s)
- (j) Veteran Health Education Coordinator

(3) Ex-Officio Non-Voting Members.

- (a) Infectious Diseases Fellows
- (b) Laboratory Information System Manager
- (c) Quality Management Coordinator
- (d) Ad-hoc invited guests from other departments

3. RESPONSIBILITIES

- a. **Chairs.** The Chairs are responsible for:

(1) Performing an annual evaluation based on VHA Directive 1031 with a report submitted to the Pharmacy and Therapeutics Committee, containing recommendations forwarded to the Clinical Executive Board

(2) Developing and implementing a hospital wide antibiotic stewardship program that is based on nationally recognized guidelines to monitor and improve the use of antibiotics

(3) Communicating and collaborating with the medical staff, nursing leadership, and pharmacy leadership, as well as with the hospital's infection prevention and control and quality assessment and performance improvement programs on antibiotic use issues

(4) Providing competency-based training and education for staff, including medical staff, on the practical applications of antibiotic stewardship guidelines, policies, and procedures

(5) Overseeing submission of local institutional antimicrobial use data to National Healthcare Safety Network (NHSN) Antimicrobial Use Option as per the VHA Directive 1031.

(6) Monitoring overall function of the program, identifying cases of concern, updating the ASP committee on ASP activities during scheduled meetings, and supervising ASP projects carried out within the hospital using a variety of mechanisms to improve the use of antimicrobial agents. These may include, but are not limited to, the following:

(a) Prospective review and feedback regarding antibiotic prescribing practices, including the treatment of positive blood cultures, by a member of the antibiotic stewardship program feedback

(b) Formulary restrictions and prior authorization for specific antibiotics that includes an internal review and approval process prior to use

(c) Ensure the facility's NHSN's Annual Survey and Monthly Reporting Plans are completed and the facility's floor specialty designations and mapping within NHSN are accurate.

(d) Competency-based education to other health care professionals regarding stewardship ideologies and practices and optimal use of antimicrobials at an annual minimum.

(e) Guidelines and/or clinical pathways

(f) Streamlining and/or de-escalation of therapy

(g) Dose optimization.

(h) Parenteral to oral conversion of antimicrobial agents

(i) Computer based surveillance of antimicrobial use and resistance patterns.

(j) Collaboration with microbiology and pathology to improve diagnostics and reporting.

(k) Anti-retroviral stewardship to optimize therapy for Veterans living with Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV)

(l) Encouraging Infectious Diseases Consultation when indicated

(m) Engaging in research and quality improvement projects related to antimicrobial use

b. **Committee/Council/Board/Group/Subcommittee.** The committee is responsible for:

(1) Attending scheduled ASP committee meetings

(2) Voting (if a voting member) on committee actions

(3) Monitoring general antibiotic use to ensure that patients are receiving the best possible therapy with a goal to maximize efficacy, minimize toxicity, and improve cost-effective usage of antimicrobials within this institution.

(4) Ensuring that the medical center has available the most appropriate diagnostic techniques for identification of antimicrobial resistant microorganisms and an efficient reporting system to alert providers of these findings.

(5) Developing educational initiatives in order to maximize the safe and effective use of antimicrobial agents.

4. MEETINGS

The committee meets at least twice yearly and when necessary, at the call of the Chair(s).

5. REFERENCES

a. VHA Directive 1031, Antimicrobial Stewardship Programs, dated September 22, 2023, https://www.va.gov/vhapublications/ViewPublication.asp?pub_ID=11458.

b. Implementing an Antibiotic Stewardship Program: Guidelines by the Infectious Disease Society of America and the Society for Healthcare Epidemiology of America. Clinical Infectious Diseases 2016; 62(10):e51-e77.

c. Core Elements of Antimicrobial Stewardship from CDC.
<https://www.cdc.gov/antibiotic-use/hcp/core-elements/index.html>

d. Core Elements of Antibiotic Stewardship for Nursing Homes
<https://www.cdc.gov/antibiotic-use/hcp/core-elements/nursing-homes-antibiotic-stewardship.html>

e. Core Elements of Outpatient Antibiotic Stewardship
<https://www.cdc.gov/antibiotic-use/hcp/core-elements/outpatient-antibiotic-stewardship.html>

f. Insights from the Society of Infectious Diseases Pharmacists on Antimicrobial Stewardship Guidelines from the Infectious Diseases Society of America and Society for Healthcare Epidemiology of America. Pharmacotherapy 2009; 29:593-607

g. Antibiotic Stewardship Resources from The Joint Commission
<https://www.jointcommission.org/resources/patient-safety-topics/infection-prevention-and-control/antibiotic-stewardship/>

h. The Joint Commission manual – Medication Management Chapter 09.01.01

6. REVIEW

Internal review of charter annually at discretion of committee chairs, during changes to the governing document (for example, national policy or a health care accreditation body mandate), and at recertification. All records regardless of format (e.g., paper, electronic, electronic systems) created by this policy must be managed as required by the National Archives and Records Administration approved records schedules found in VHA Records Control Schedule 10-1.

7. RECERTIFICATION

This charter is scheduled for recertification on or before the last working day of December 2029.

8. SIGNATORY AUTHORITY

Ginny L. Creasman, Pharm.D., FACHE
Medical Center Director
Date Approved: Month Day, Year

NOTE: *The signature remains valid until rescinded by an appropriate administrative action.*

Policy Memorandum Distribution Tracking Sheet

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